

What a drip

Leaves cannot absorb water, so they have drainage systems to stop them drowning. Water collects in ridges and runs off a “drip-tip” on the end of the leaf.

Drip-tip —

Some leaves turn red from waste products stored inside.

Changing colour

Leaves get their green colour from chlorophyll, which they use to make food. When the leaves rest in the autumn, the chlorophyll fades away, revealing the reds and yellows of other chemicals in the leaf.

The leaflets of a compound leaf grow straight from the stalk, not from buds.



The “leaves” of wild asparagus are really feathery stems that can stand up to gales.

Compound

Feathery